

JENNIFER JONES

Fractional Hospitality Executive | Strategic Advisor | Revenue Growth | Event and Venue Consulting

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Fractional hospitality executive and strategic consultant in the industry since 1998, with 28 years of experience and 15 years of executive leadership, and a career spanning San Francisco, New York, Los Angeles, and markets throughout California in various roles. I help hospitality organizations, venues, and corporate clients increase revenue, strengthen operations, and elevate the guest experience. As the Founder of Gold Standard Events Consulting, I partner with businesses that need senior-level leadership without the overhead of a full-time executive. My expertise spans event strategy, venue operations, destination management, business development, sales leadership, marketing, brand identity, and organizational growth. Throughout my career, I have generated more than \$10M in event revenue, built and led high-performing teams, launched new hospitality concepts, optimized event operations, and developed strategic partnerships that drive measurable business results. I bring an entrepreneurial mindset, collaborative leadership style, and hands-on approach to helping organizations solve complex challenges, accelerate growth, and deliver exceptional client experiences.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Event Strategy and Consulting | Boutique DMC Services | Venue and Restaurant Consulting
Sales and Marketing | Corporate Meetings and Incentives | Revenue Growth Strategy
Sales Team Development and Training | Destination Management | Attendee Engagement Strategy
Vendor Sourcing and Negotiation | CRM Implementation | Budget Development and Cost Analysis
Website Development and Brand Identity | Multi-Concept Brand Cohesion | Program Design and Branding
Small Business Consulting | Business Formation and Licensing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Gold Standard Events Consulting (GS Events) Jun 2020 - Present

Founder and Principal Consultant | California | National and International

- Founded Gold Standard Events Consulting as a boutique strategic consulting firm, evolving from hospitality concept development into high-level event strategy and venue consulting advisory services for corporate clients and hospitality properties nationwide.
- Serve corporate meeting planners as a boutique DMC partner and trusted local market expert, delivering end-to-end destination management support including vendor sourcing and vetting, site selection, hotel block negotiation, event concept development, companion programming, and attendee experience strategy aligned with measurable business objectives.
- Design and execute fully customized incentive programs, multi-city corporate retreats, conferences, and special events, handling all program strategy, vendor ecosystem management, and on-site coordination to deliver seamless, premium experiences.
- Develop and implement sales and marketing strategies for hospitality clients, including brand partnerships, promotional campaigns, and lead generation programs that drive measurable revenue growth.
- Build client websites and brand identity systems, leading brand restructuring engagements that unify messaging, visuals, and digital presence into one cohesive brand across multiple concepts and revenue centers.
- Partner with restaurants, event venues, and hospitality properties as an outsourced Director of Events, building event sales teams from the ground up, developing CRM systems, implementing revenue frameworks, and driving sustained profitability.
- Develop comprehensive consulting frameworks for hospitality concept turnarounds, restructuring events departments, creating brand partnership strategies, and repositioning venues for increased market share and event revenue.
- Operate a selective, high-touch client model with a focused roster of engagements annually, ensuring each client receives a customized, results-oriented consulting partnership.

russell harris EVENT GROUP Nov 2024 - May 2025

Director of Accounts, Meetings and Incentives (Consultant) | Los Angeles, CA | Hybrid

- Managed and grew national corporate client accounts, overseeing the planning and execution of high-impact meetings and incentive programs for organizations across diverse industries.
- Drove revenue growth in the meetings and incentives specialty through strategic relationship management, proactive business development, and seamless program execution that consistently delivered measurable outcomes.

- Applied strategic thinking, operational expertise, and relationship management to create event experiences that drove attendee engagement and delivered exceptional value to corporate clients.

Small Business Development Center (SBDC) Jan 2023 - Jun 2025

Part-Time Business Consultant, Restaurant and Event Venue Division | LA County and Inland Valley, CA

- Advised aspiring and emerging entrepreneurs across LA County and the Inland Valley on launching and scaling food and beverage businesses including restaurants, coffee shops, food trucks, catering operations, and event planning ventures.
- Co-consulted on small business financing, guiding clients through the loan application process, financial statement preparation, and documentation requirements needed to secure capital for new and growing concepts.
- Assisted clients with site selection and property sourcing, evaluating locations aligned with business goals, target demographics, and operational requirements.
- Developed customized sales, marketing, and social media strategies to help restaurant and hospitality clients build brand visibility, attract customers, and drive revenue growth.
- Guided entrepreneurs through business formation, including concept naming, brand development, and entity registration with the State of California.
- Designed and facilitated a Restaurant Business Cohort for SBDC Los Angeles, delivering structured curriculum and mentorship to a cohort of aspiring and emerging restaurant owners.

CSI DMC Feb 2022 - Oct 2024

Senior Account Executive and Business Development | California | Remote

- Generated \$4.5M+ in sales while managing multiple high-profile corporate accounts across diverse industries, consistently achieving and exceeding annual sales goals in one of the most competitive DMC markets in the country.
- Owned a statewide luxury territory spanning San Diego to Napa, serving Fortune 500 and Fortune 100 clients, with a concentration in technology companies, as a trusted strategic partner for corporate meeting planners seeking California DMC expertise.
- Partnered with luxury hotels and resorts across the state to deliver executive retreats, sales kickoff meetings, and incentive programs, designing bespoke off-site experiences built around a deep understanding of what each client wanted their guests to receive.
- Delivered full destination management services including site sourcing, hotel block negotiation, vendor coordination, transportation, companion programming, and custom event design for corporate groups of all sizes.
- Led contract negotiation and vendor relationship management, securing favorable pricing and agreements that maximized client value while preserving program quality.
- Built strategic hotel and venue partnerships with Conrad Los Angeles, Pendry San Diego, Hard Rock San Diego, and Sheraton Universal to enhance client offerings and drive business growth.
- Trained, mentored, and coached incoming sales team members to effectively service new and existing accounts, building team capability and consistent performance.

Farmhouse Los Angeles Mar 2019 - Jun 2020

Director of Events | Los Angeles, CA (Closed due to COVID-19)

- Rebuilt the Private Events Department from scratch, designing and implementing a new CRM, credit card processing system, and sales framework that immediately drove revenue growth.
- Increased private event sales by 200% while restructuring, redeveloping, and rebranding the entire private events department within a condensed timeframe.
- Developed comprehensive sales and marketing strategies leveraging property strengths and brand partnerships to capture new corporate and social event revenue.
- Managed enterprise-level events including corporate buyouts, conferences, and meetings, overseeing all contract negotiation, logistics, staffing, and client relations.

The Mayfair Hotel Jun 2018 - Mar 2019

Catering Sales Manager | Los Angeles, CA

- Joined the Grand Re-Opening team of The Mayfair Hotel following the property's \$50 million renovation, generating \$550,000 in catering and event revenue within 6 months despite the hotel being open and operational for only a portion of that period.
- Managed all aspects of event sales including proposals, contract negotiation, entertainment, staffing, decor, and on-site event coordination.

- Applied sales forecasting and strategic planning to verify profitability, generating new leads through cold calling, creative advertising, and marketing strategy.

CITRUS Hospitality Management Dec 2016 - Jun 2018

Special Event Sales Manager | Los Angeles, CA

- Owned sales and revenue growth for two landmark revenue centers: Perch LA, the first rooftop restaurant in Downtown Los Angeles atop the historic Pershing Square Building, featuring three floors of event space across terrace dining, rooftop dining, and indoor banquet rooms, and Mrs. Fish, a three-floor subterranean dining and event venue.
- Exceeded annual sales goals by 22%, becoming the top-selling Event Sales Manager at the company, generating \$1.5M in 2017 for a roster including Fortune 500 corporate clients.
- Managed all aspects of event management including proposals, contract negotiation, entertainment, and decor for high-profile corporate accounts.
- Revamped special event decor and created comprehensive SOPs for all banquet staff, covering attire, steps of service, setup, and breakdown procedures.
- Designed and launched social media marketing campaigns and collateral that expanded brand visibility and attracted new corporate accounts.

INDUSTRY LEADERSHIP AND PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

MPI Southern California Chapter (MPISCC) Jan 2025 - Jan 2026

Director of Education and Professional Development | Southern California

- Led the creation of meaningful learning opportunities and educational programs for the MPI Southern California membership, curating content, organizing speaker events, and fostering career advancement for meetings and events industry professionals.

Fete 2024 - 2026

Board Member | Events and Hospitality Community

- Served on the board of Fete, contributing strategic direction and industry expertise to support the organization's mission and growth within the events and hospitality community.

ADDITIONAL BACKGROUND

Foods To Fit LLC Sep 2013 - Dec 2016

Owner and CEO | Studio City, CA

Founded and operated a certified organic meal delivery service. Managed all business operations including marketing strategy, financial oversight, vendor relationships, and client service.

Santa Anita Park May 2013 - Sep 2014

VIP Hostess | Arcadia, CA

Serviced VIP guests in the Suites and Chandler Room at one of the country's premier racing venues. Responsible for all banquet and catering coordination in a high-volume, fast-paced environment.

STK Downtown, The ONE Group 2006 - 2012

Banquets, Catering and Events | New York, NY

Seven years inside The ONE Group's multi-concept luxury hospitality portfolio, supporting banquet, catering, and event operations at STK Downtown and gaining firsthand experience in how multiple distinct restaurant concepts operate cohesively under one unified brand.

MEGU Midtown 2005 - 2006

Fine Dining Captain | New York, NY

Delivered white-glove service in one of New York City's premier luxury Japanese fine dining destinations, serving high-profile clientele in a Forbes-caliber service environment.

EDUCATION

San Francisco State University | Bachelor of Fine Arts, Dance Performance and Choreography | Minor: Speech Communications

The Ailey School | Certificate of Dance | New York City, NY